



Of India's 12 open access fuel farms, 7 are at Adani-operated airports.

negotiate better deals. If one supplier is hit harder by a price surge, airlines can pivot to others — cushioning the blow of international market turbulence.

Efficiency, Safety and Scale

The benefits go beyond pricing:

- Faster turnarounds: Hydrant refuelling saves crucial minutes per aircraft.
- Improved safety: Reduced vehicle traffic on the tarmac lowers accident risks.
- Lower costs: Open Access models can reduce fuel-related expenses significantly.
- Future readiness: Designed for scalability, these systems can absorb traffic growth without disruptive upgrades.

Strategically, this builds resilience into India's aviation ecosystem — a long-term advantage as the country adds hundreds of new airports over the coming decades.

Mumbai Sets a Scorching Pace

Mumbai, India's second-busiest airport, already operates a world-class hydrant refuelling system that handles immense passenger volumes efficiently. Similar installations are being replicated across Lucknow, Ahmedabad, Guwahati, Thiruvananthapuram, Jaipur and the upcoming NMIA, demonstrating how scalable the model is.

Each rollout strengthens airline flexibility, reduces exposure to bottlenecks, and enhances the passenger experience through smoother operations.

A Quiet Revolution is Unfolding in the Skies

Passengers may notice new runways and terminals, but some of the most impactful changes happen behind the scenes. The rise of open access fuel farms and hydrant system is one such invisible revolution — one that is strengthening India's aviation sector for decades of growth ahead.

By championing this model, the Adani Group is not just upgrading infrastructure; it is embedding resilience, efficiency, and competitiveness into the very foundation of Indian aviation. For airlines and passengers alike, the payoff will be smoother journeys, stronger

Refuelling Methods: A Comparison

1. Hydrant System - A method suited for mid-to-large airports

Process:

- Fuel stored centrally is distributed through underground pipelines across airport
- Hydrant pits at aircraft bays connect directly to fuel lines
- The refuelling vehicle (Hydrant Dispenser) draws fuel directly from underground pits, bypassing topping up at the static storage and reducing airport vehicle movement

Benefits:

- 3-4x faster refuelling for wide-body aircraft
- No limitation on quantity of fuel, hence, suited for long-haul flights
- High fuel flow rate is the preferred mode for airlines, especially international carriers
- Faster refuelling means reduced aircraft turnaround time
- Less apron traffic reduces congestion around aircraft, enhances safety
- Less manpower
- Ideal for handling high passenger volume

2. Bowser Refuelling - Conventional method using mobile fuel trucks called bowsters

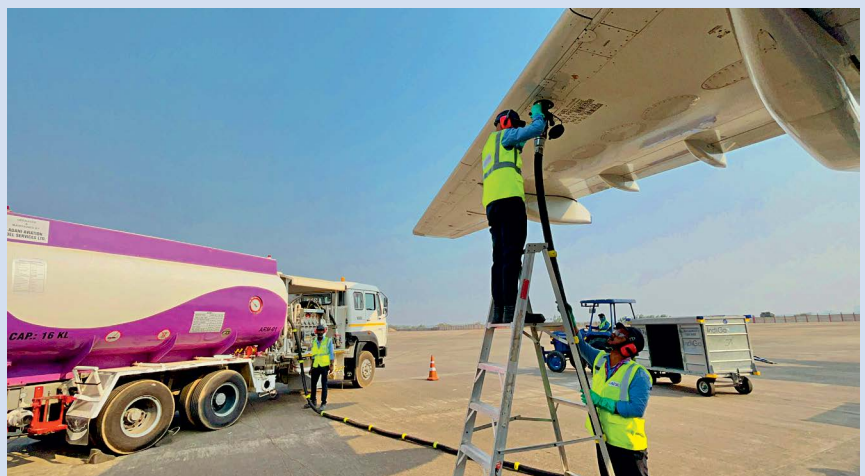
Process:

- Fuel is stored in bowsters, which drive to each aircraft
- Refuelling done manually using a pump driven by engine power
- Best suited for small airports, usually less than 3 million passengers per annum

Limitations:

- Slower operations, especially during peak hours
- Higher apron congestion
- For flights with higher fuel requirements, multiple bowsters are needed for refuelling

networks and fares less exposed to global shocks. As India's aviation boom accelerates, the diversified conglomerate's open access fuel farms are ensuring the sector can fly higher, faster and more sustainably — no matter how turbulent the global fuel market becomes.



Tanker trucks or bowsters ferry fuel to parked planes. While effective, this means constant vehicle movement on the airside, raising safety risks and slowing aircraft turnaround times.